WAKE COUNTY PUBLIC SCHOOL SYSTEM

School Forms

Settings Reference

Wake County Public School System
October 2026

Companion to the Admin Guide

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Settings at a glance

1. About Settings

Everything an administrator configures lives on one page, **Settings**, arranged as twelve collapsible sections. Click a section's heading to open it; the others stay closed, so the page never becomes a wall of controls.

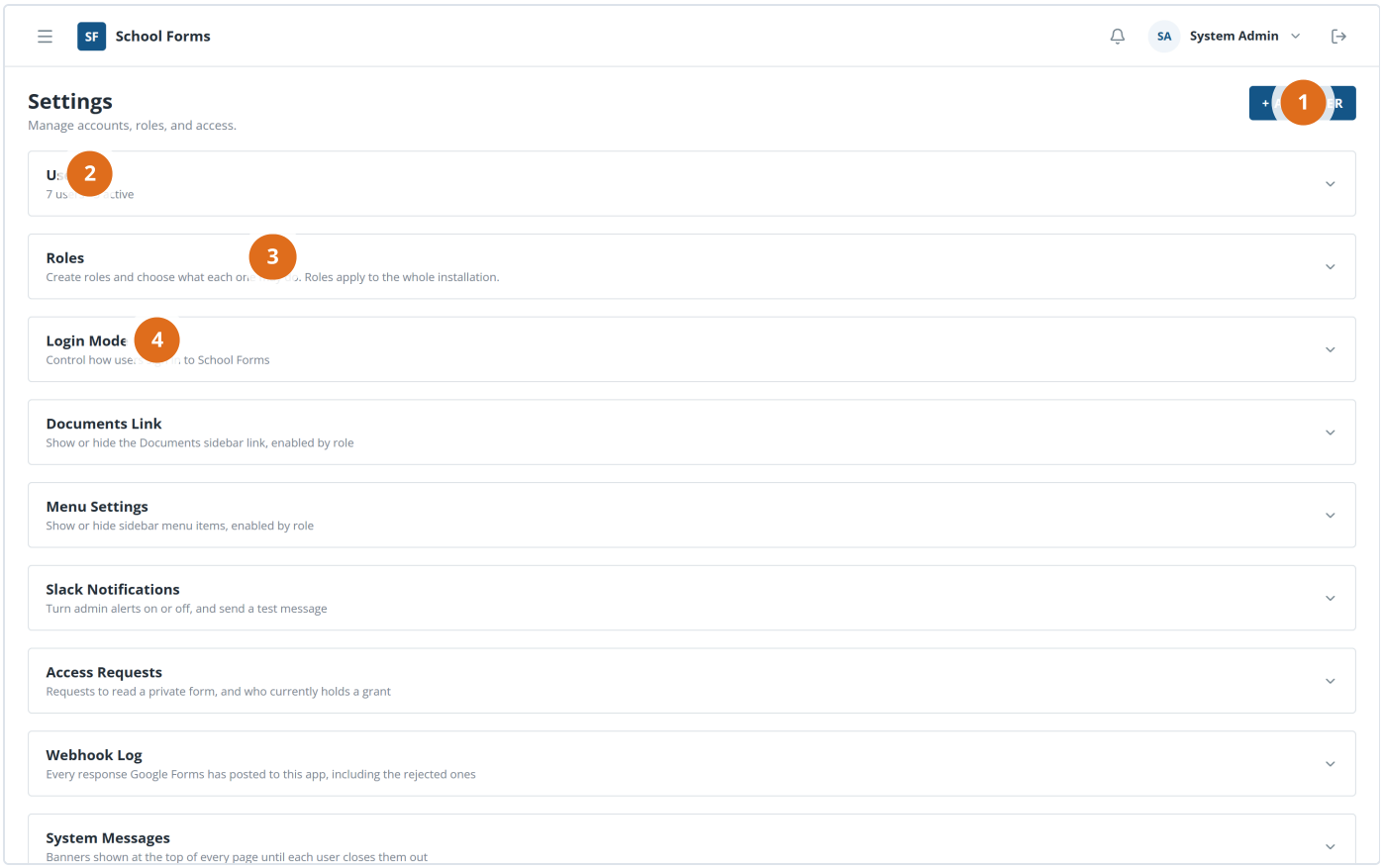


Figure 1 — The Settings page.

1. **+ Add User** — the one action that sits above the sections.
2. **Users** — accounts, roles and form access. Chapter 2.
3. **Roles** — what each role may do. Chapter 3.
4. **Login Mode** — and, below it, **Documents Link** and **Menu Settings**: how the app appears to each role. Chapters 4–6.

Further down the same page: Slack Notifications, Access Requests, Webhook Log, System Messages, Organizations, Schools and School Name Matching — chapters 7 to 13.

> **Changes save as you make them**
>
> Most switches and role buttons save immediately — there is no page-wide Save. Where a change is risky, the app asks you to confirm first, and the confirmation states what will happen.

You can only manage users in your own organization

If your installation has more than one organization, the Users section lists and edits only your own. That is a boundary, not a bug.

2. Users

The **Users** section lists every account in your organization, with how many are active.

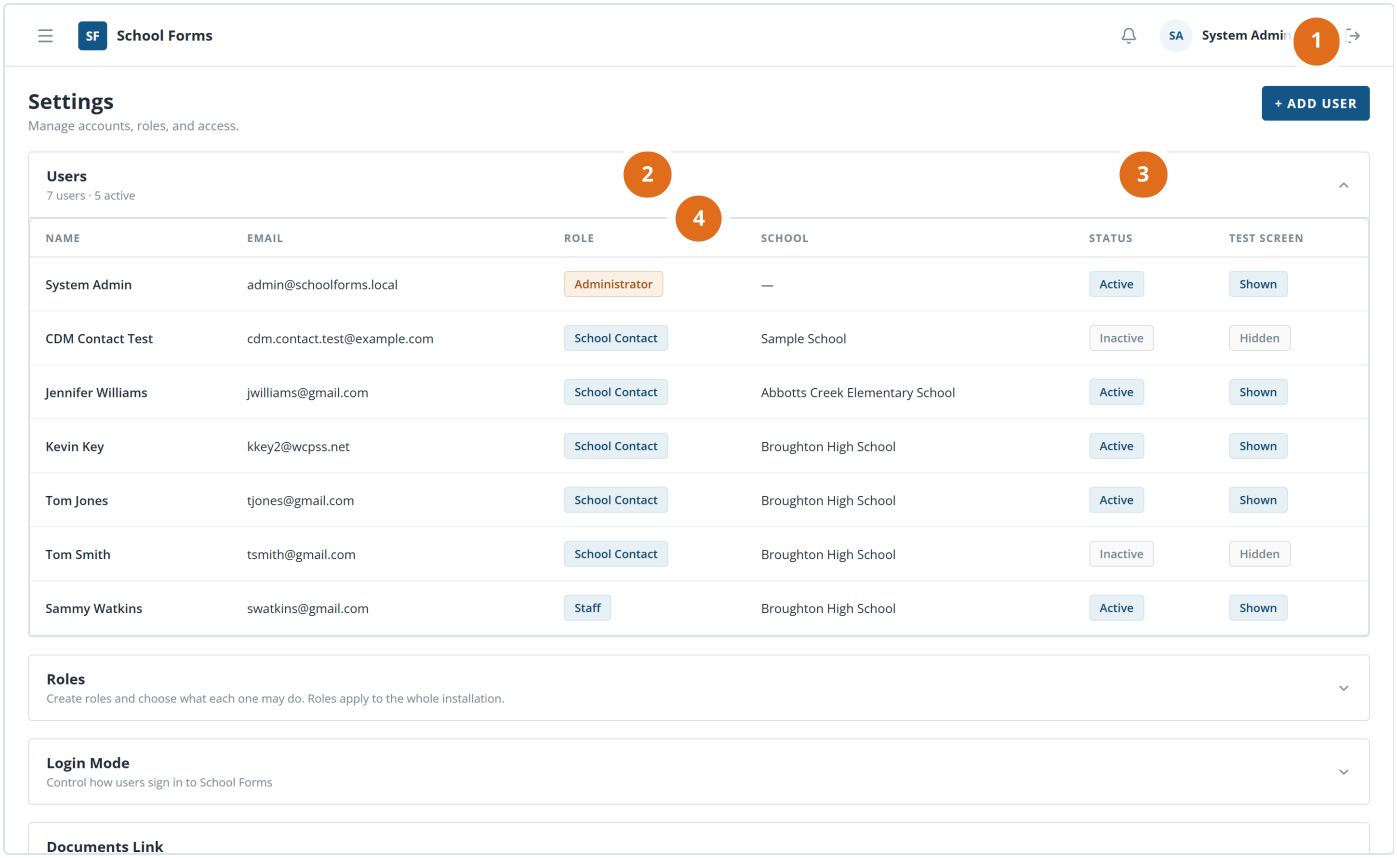


Figure 2 — The Users list.

1. **+ Add User** creates an account.
2. The **Role** column — Admin, Staff, School Contact, or a role you created.
3. The **Status** column — Active or Inactive.
4. A row. Click it to open the **Edit User** panel (Figure 3).

Each row also shows the account's **Name**, **Email** and **School**.

2.1 Editing a user

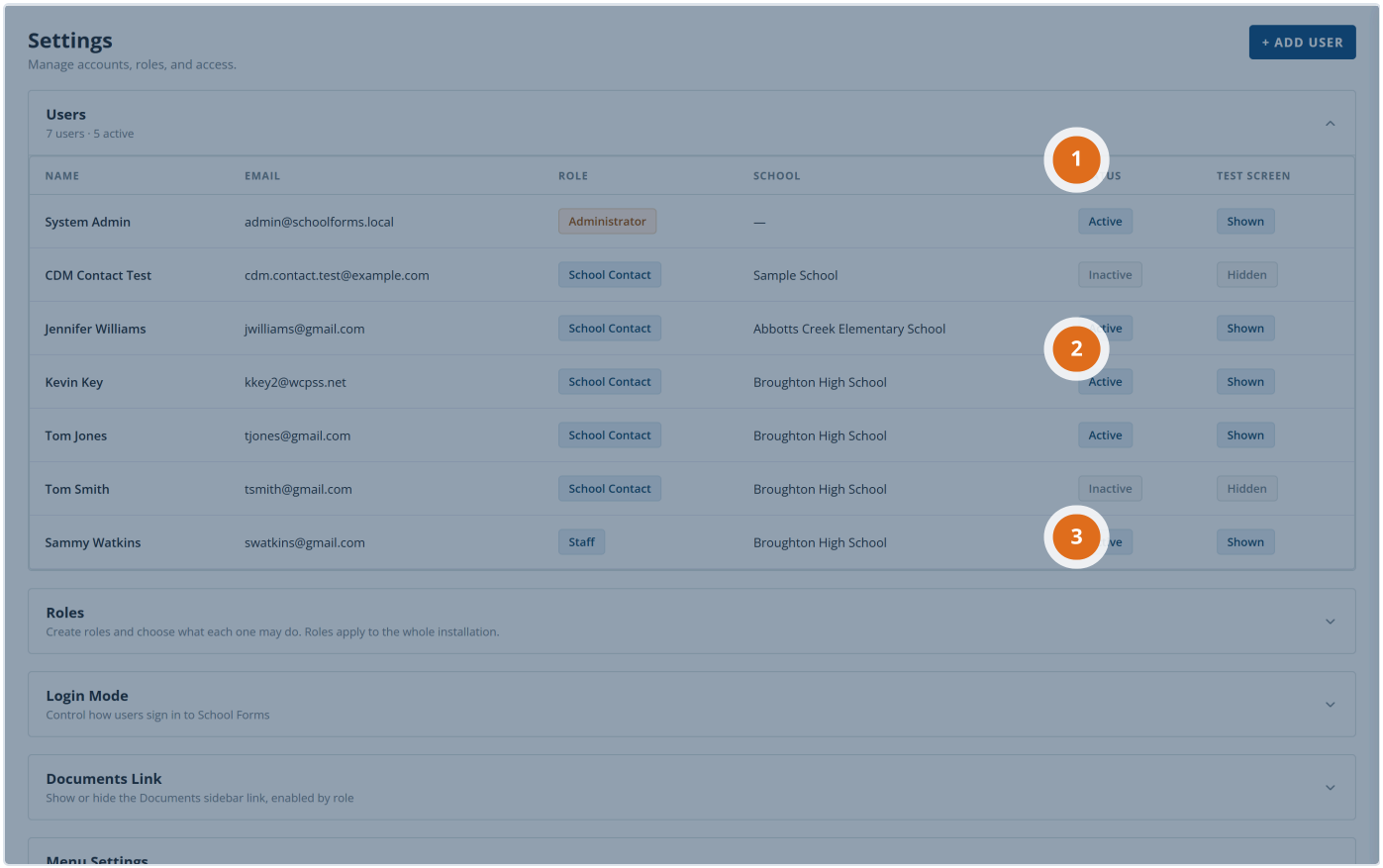


Figure 3 — The Edit User panel.

1. **Display name**, **Email**, **Role**, **Organization** and **School**, plus the **Active** switch.
2. **Forms** — one checkbox per *private* form. Ticking grants access; unticking takes it away. Public forms are not listed because everyone already has them.
3. **Form access** — a read-only record of this account's grants and why each exists (grandfathered, declined, or removed). It has no buttons: the checkboxes above are the only control.

The panel's own save button applies all of it together.

2.2 Passwords and temporary passwords

There is no "forgot password" link. When someone is locked out, an administrator issues a **temporary password** from this panel. The user signs in with it once and is then required to choose a new password before they can reach any other page.

> **Why the user must change it**
>
> A temporary password is known to you as well as to them. Forcing a change at first sign-in is what stops it from becoming a permanent shared secret. The row shows a marker while that change is still outstanding.

You cannot deactivate your own account

The app refuses it, so an installation can never be left without an active administrator.

3. Roles

Roles are what you assign to accounts. Each one carries three access flags and an optional school scope, and the flags apply across the whole installation.

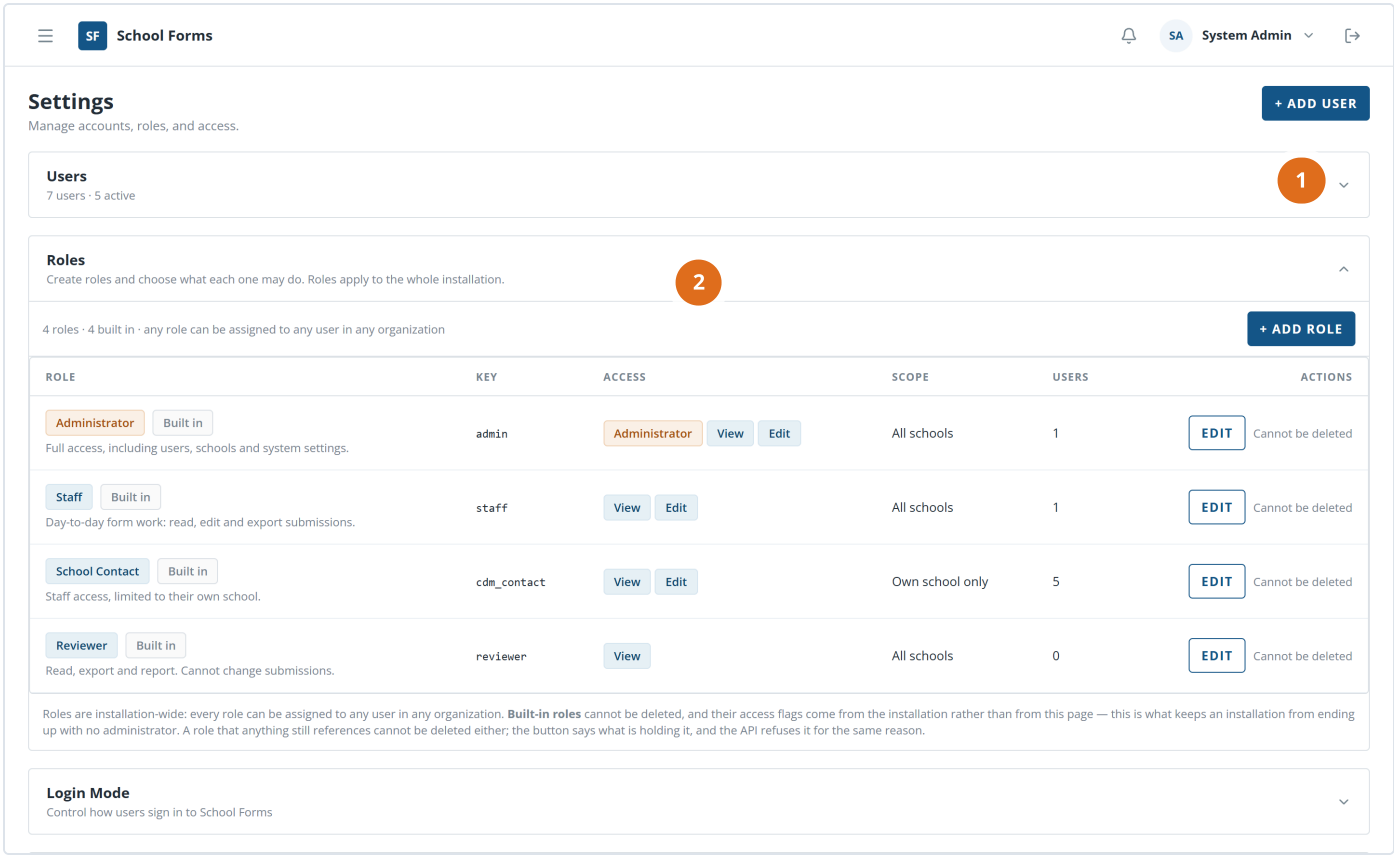


Figure 4 — The Roles list.

1. **+ Add Role**.
2. A role row. It carries the role's **label** and key, its flags (**View submissions**, **Edit submissions**, **Limited to their own school**), an **Administrator** badge where it manages settings, and a **Usage** count of the users, fields, messages and menu items that reference it.

A role in use cannot be deleted until those references are cleared.

3.1 Built-in roles

ROLE	BUILT IN?	NOTES
Admin	Yes	Full access, including Settings. Cannot be deleted.
Staff	Yes	Sees every school in the organization.
School Contact	Yes	Limited to their own school.
Any role you create	No	Starts with no access to existing staff-only fields or private forms.

> **Built-in roles are re-applied at every start**
>
> The installation re-creates its built-in roles and resets their access flags whenever it starts. That is what keeps an installation from ending up with nobody able to administer it — and it means editing a built-in role's flags will not stick. Create a new role instead.

3.2 Creating a role

1. Click **+ Add Role**.
2. Give it a **label** — the name people will see.
3. Tick the flags it needs: view, edit, school-limited, administrator.
4. Save. The role now appears in the **Role** dropdown on every user, and in the **Access** row of every staff-only field.

> **A new role sees nothing until you grant it**
>
> Creating a role does not give it access to existing private forms or staff-only fields. Grant those in **Users** → **Edit User** and in the form designer's **Access** row.

4. Login Mode

Login Mode decides what the sign-in screen does for everybody.

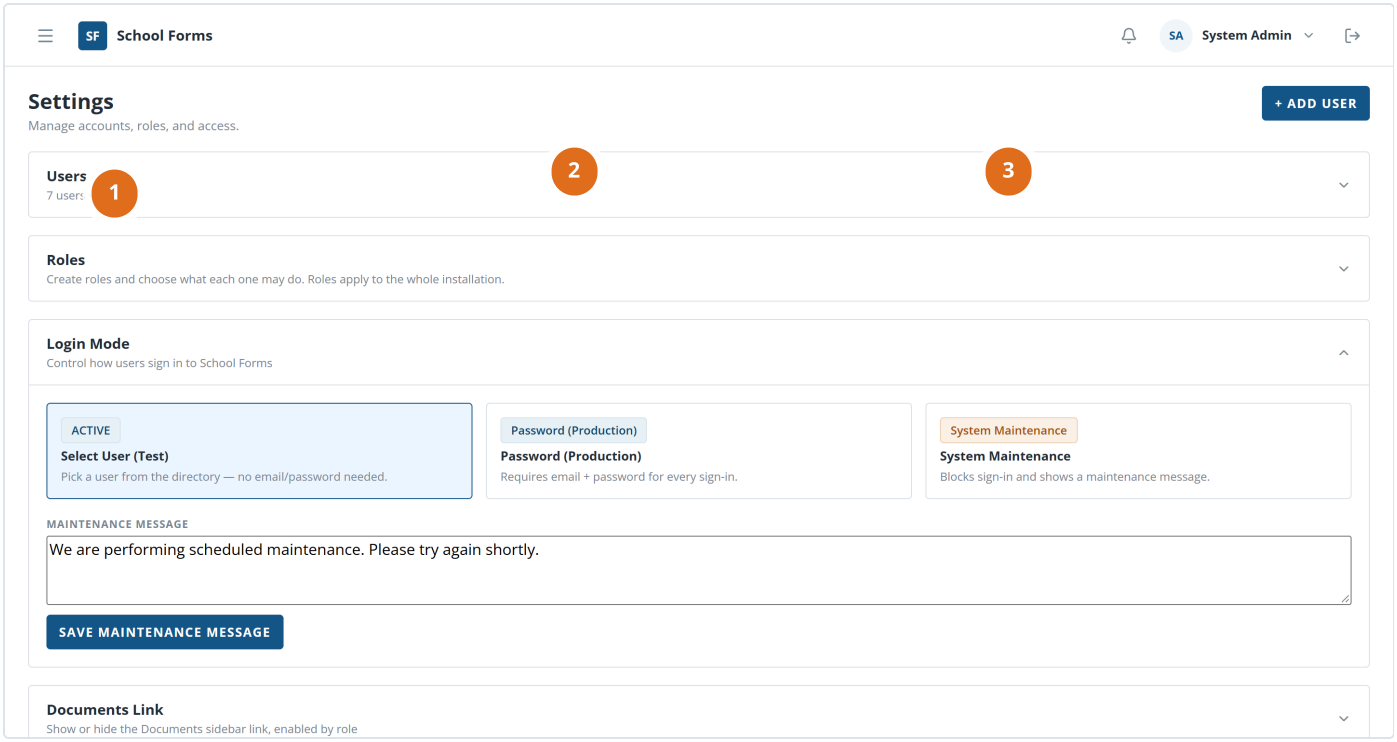


Figure 5 — The three sign-in modes.

1. **Select User (Test)** — pick a user from a directory; no password. For demonstrations and training only.
2. **Password (Production)** — email and password for every sign-in. This is the normal setting.
3. **System Maintenance** — blocks sign-in and shows a maintenance message.

> **Test mode is not a security boundary**
>
> In **Select User** mode anyone who reaches the sign-in screen can choose any account, including an administrator's. Use it only on an installation that holds no real data, and switch back to **Password** before real submissions arrive.

> **Maintenance mode is the graceful way to pause**
>
> It keeps existing sessions working for a short time while it stops new sign-ins, so you can finish a migration or restore without yanking the app out from under people mid-task.

5. Documents Link

Controls whether the **Documents** menu item exists, separately for each role.

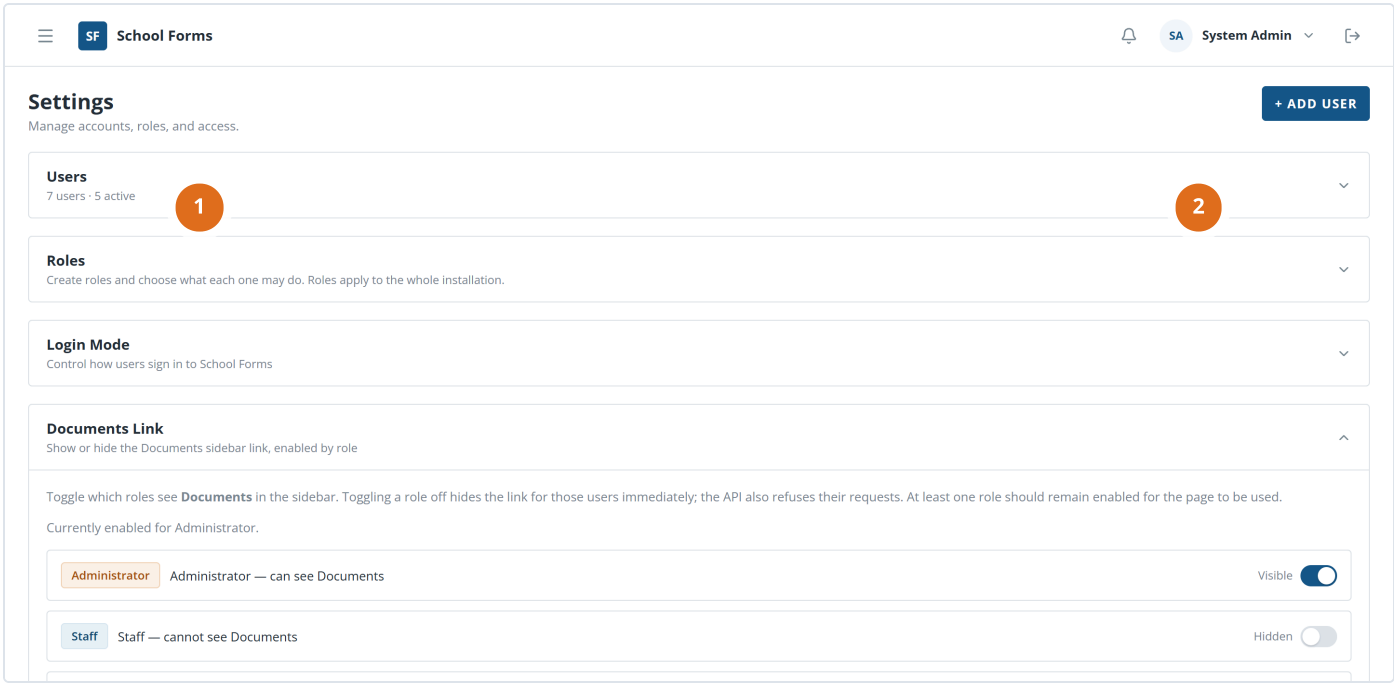


Figure 6 — Documents Link.

1. One row per role.
2. Its switch. On means that role sees **Documents** in the menu and the document line on a submission; off means neither appears.

> **This is the only switch for Documents**
>
> There is deliberately no second control for it in **Menu Settings**. If a role cannot see **Documents**, this switch is the one to check.

6. Menu Settings

Hides individual menu items from individual roles. Useful when a role should not be distracted by a section it never uses.

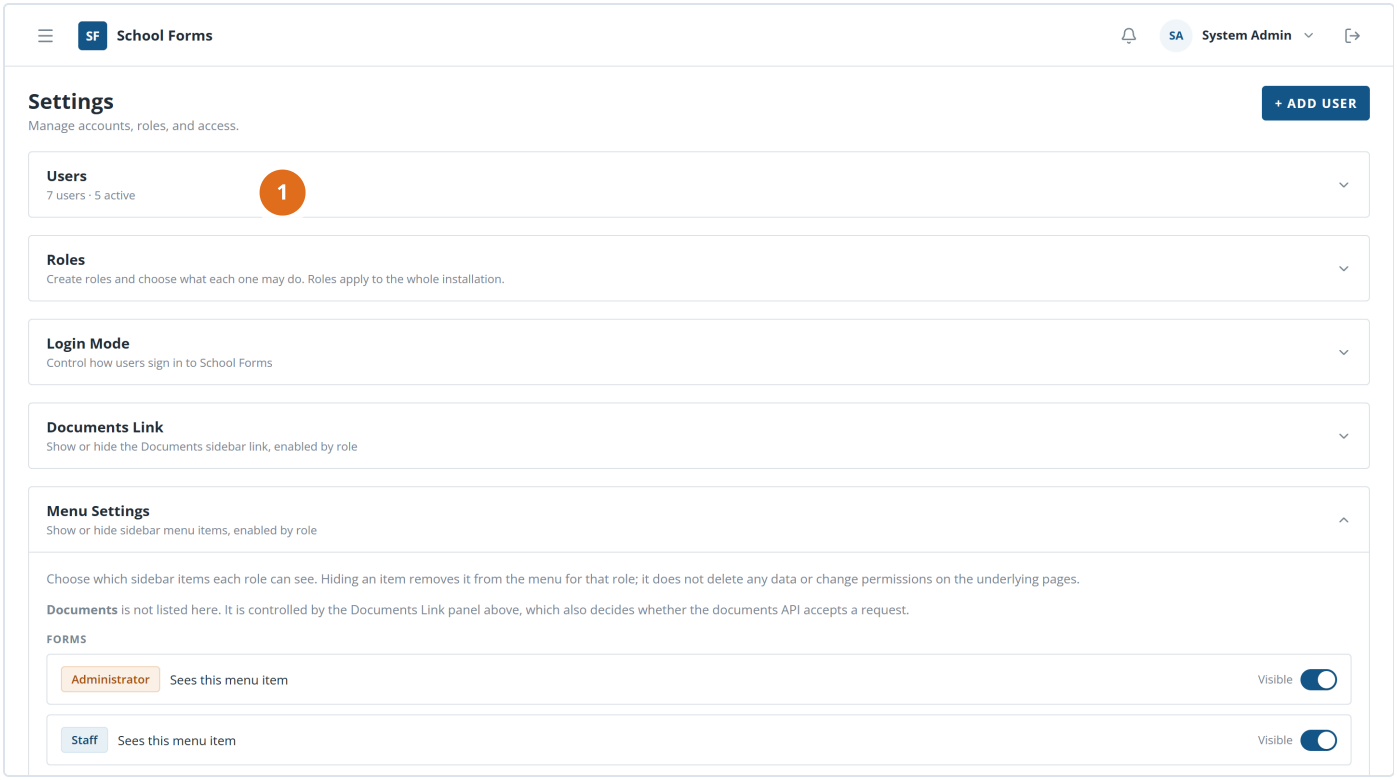


Figure 7 — Menu Settings.

1. A menu item row — **Forms**, **Available Forms**, **Access Requests** or **Reports** — with a switch per role. **Everyone** means every role, including ones created later.

> **Hiding a link is not a permission**
>
> This section tidies the menu. It does not stop someone reaching a page by typing its address — access is decided by roles, form visibility and staff-only field access. Treat it as decluttering, not security.

> **Settings is always visible to administrators**
>
> You cannot hide **Settings** from an administrator role, and the **Webhook Log** stays reachable from this page even when its menu item is off.

7. Slack Notifications

Turns administrator alerts on or off and lets you prove the connection works.

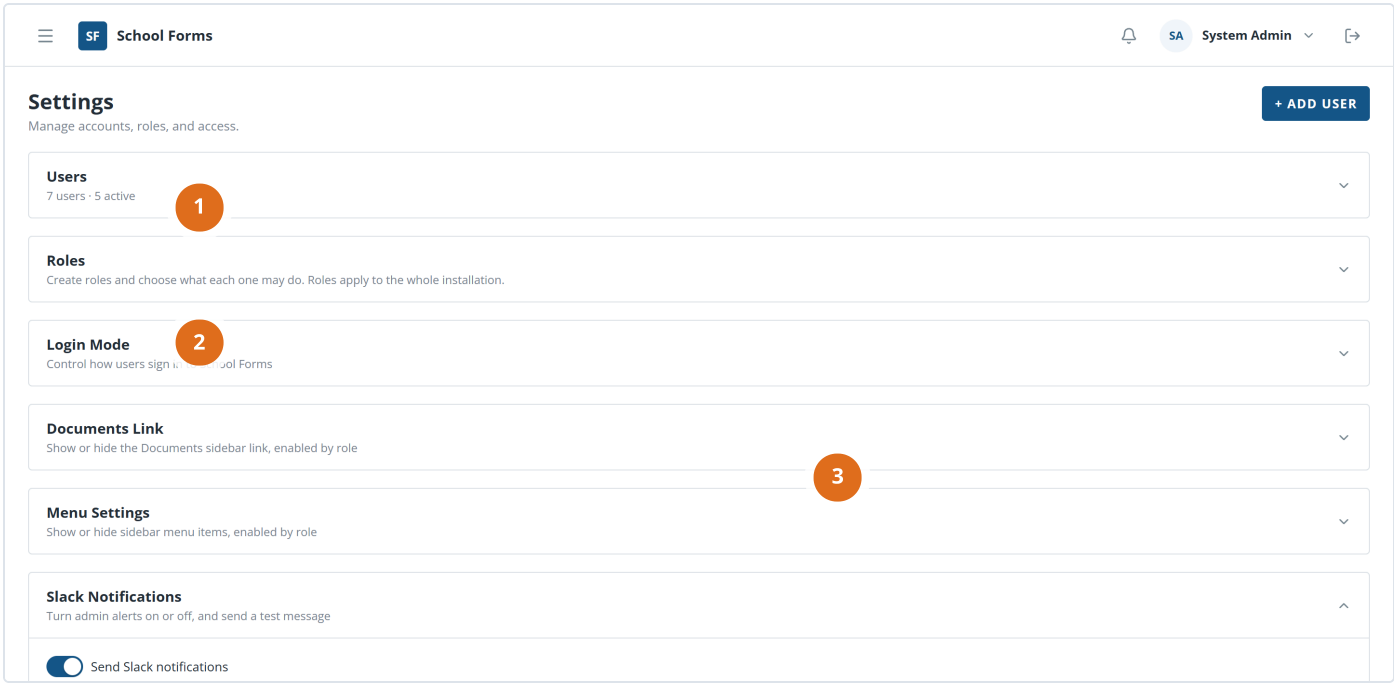


Figure 8 — Slack Notifications.

1. The on/off switch for admin alerts.
2. What the alerts are for.
3. **Send test message** — posts to the configured channel so you can confirm it arrives.

> **If the test message does not arrive**
>
> The webhook address is configured on the server, not in this page. Tell whoever maintains the installation — the test button reports the failure but cannot fix it.

8. Access Requests

The same queue as the **Access Requests** page, shown here so you can answer a request without leaving Settings.

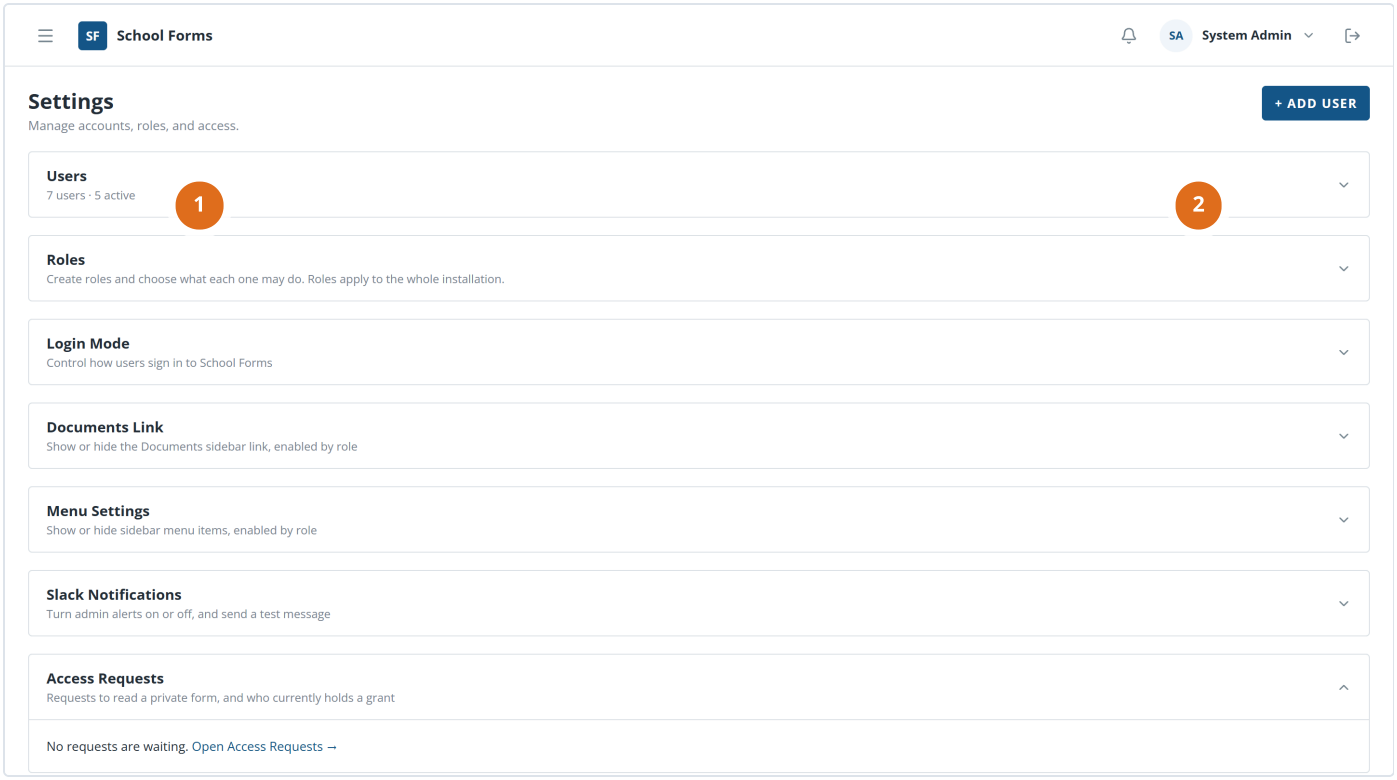


Figure 9 — Access Requests in Settings.

1. Pending requests, with who asked and for which form.
2. Approve or decline. A decline can carry a reason the requester will see.

Requests also arrive in the bell in the banner, which is always available to administrators even when the **Access Requests** menu item is hidden.

9. Webhook Log

A preview of the full log, with a link to open it.

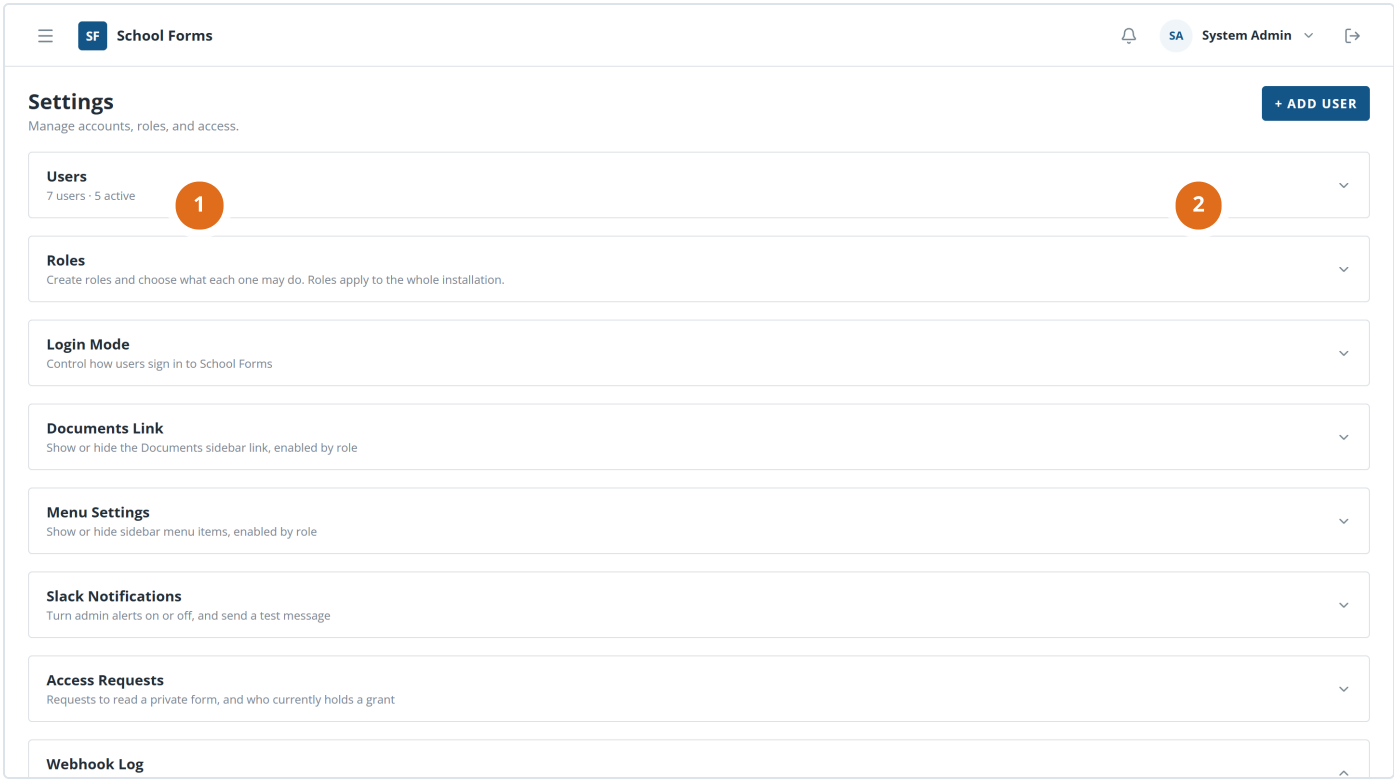


Figure 10 — Webhook Log in Settings.

1. The most recent attempts, with their outcome.
2. The link to the full **Webhook Log** page, where you can filter, inspect a payload and **Replay** a rejected response.

See the Admin Guide, Part 6, for what each rejection reason means and which ones can be replayed.

10. System Messages

Banners shown at the top of every page until each person closes them out. Use them for planned maintenance, a deadline, or a change in process.

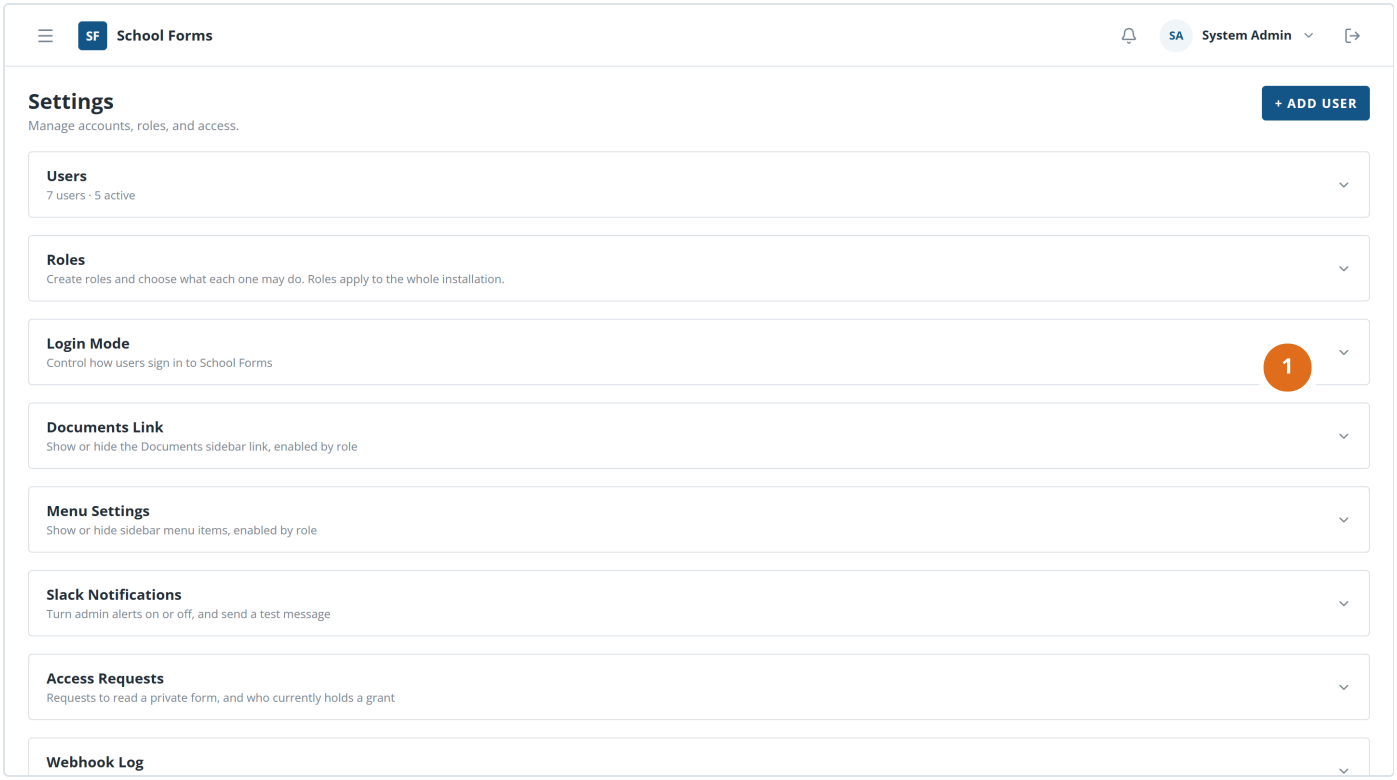


Figure 11 — System Messages.

1. **+ Add Message**. Each message has a **title**, a body, and an **audience** — everyone, or specific roles — and can be edited or removed afterwards.

Removing a message takes the banner away from everyone who has not yet closed it.

> **Dismissal is per person**
>
> Each person closes a banner for themselves only. If you need everyone to see a message again, edit it — the change makes it reappear.

11. Organizations

Organizations are tenant boundaries. Schools are shared across all of them, but accounts, forms and submissions belong to one.

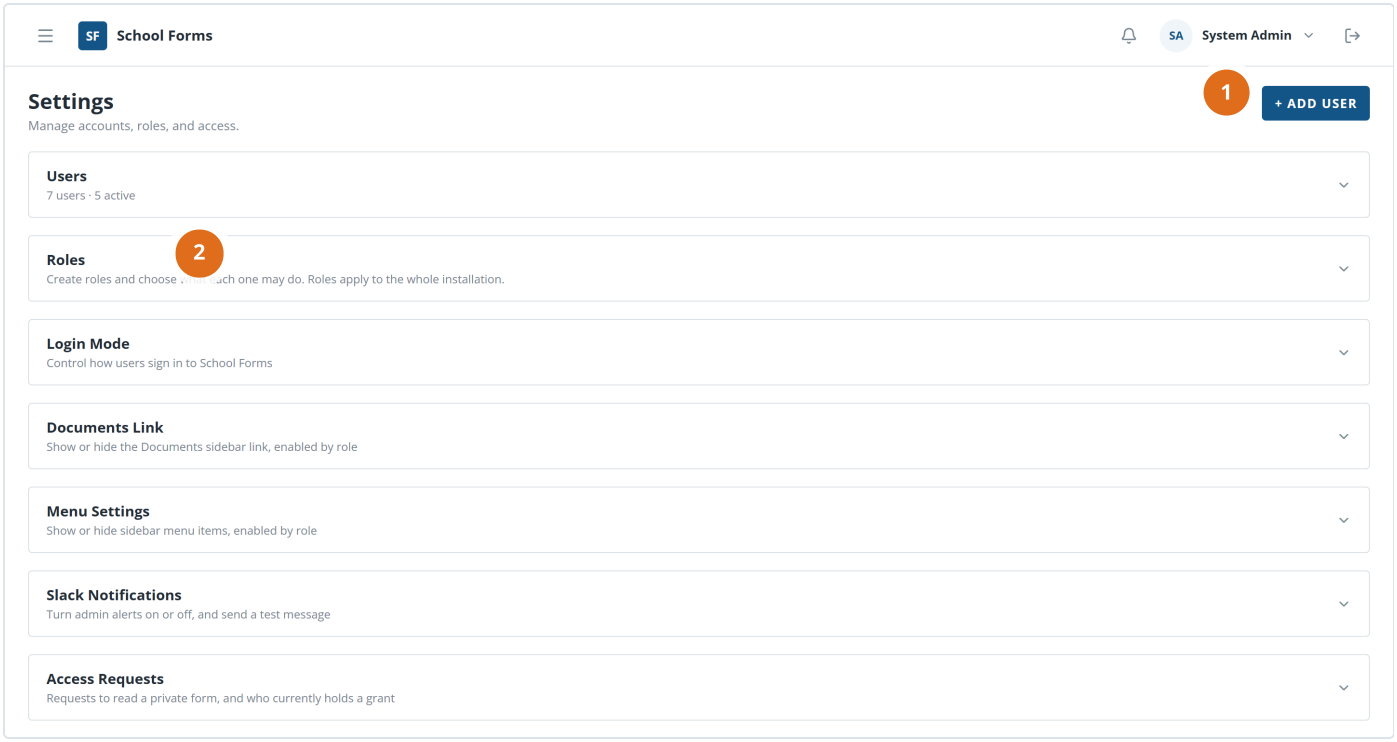


Figure 12 — Organizations.

1. **+ Add Organization**.
2. An organization. Click it to edit its name or details.

> **Most installations need only one**
>
> If your district runs a single School Forms installation, you will rarely open this section. It matters when one installation must serve separate groups that should not see each other's data.

12. Schools

The district school list, maintained by hand. It matters more than it looks: a submission is routed to a school by matching the parent's answer to a name in this list.

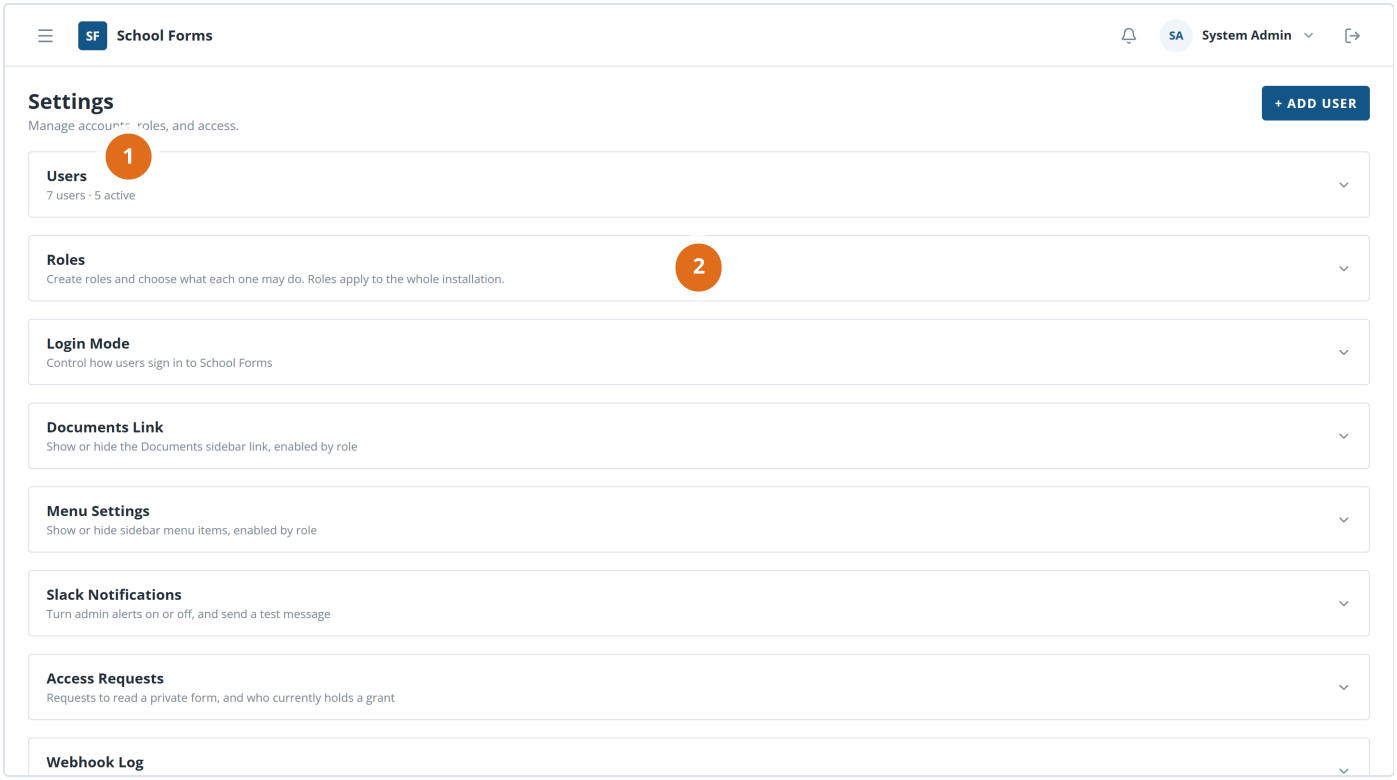


Figure 13 — Schools.

1. **Search** by name or district. **Grade Level** and **Calendar** filters sit beside it, and **Import Schools** refreshes the list from the district source.
2. A school row. Click it to edit the record.

> **Renaming a school does not rewrite old answers**
>
> A submission keeps the parent's own words. Renaming a school here changes future matching, not what was already recorded — see the next chapter for the answers that no longer match.

13. School Name Matching

When a Google Form asks for a school, parents type whatever they like — "Broughton", "Broughton High", "Broughton High School". This section lists the answers that do not match a school in the list, so you can match each one once and fix it for good.

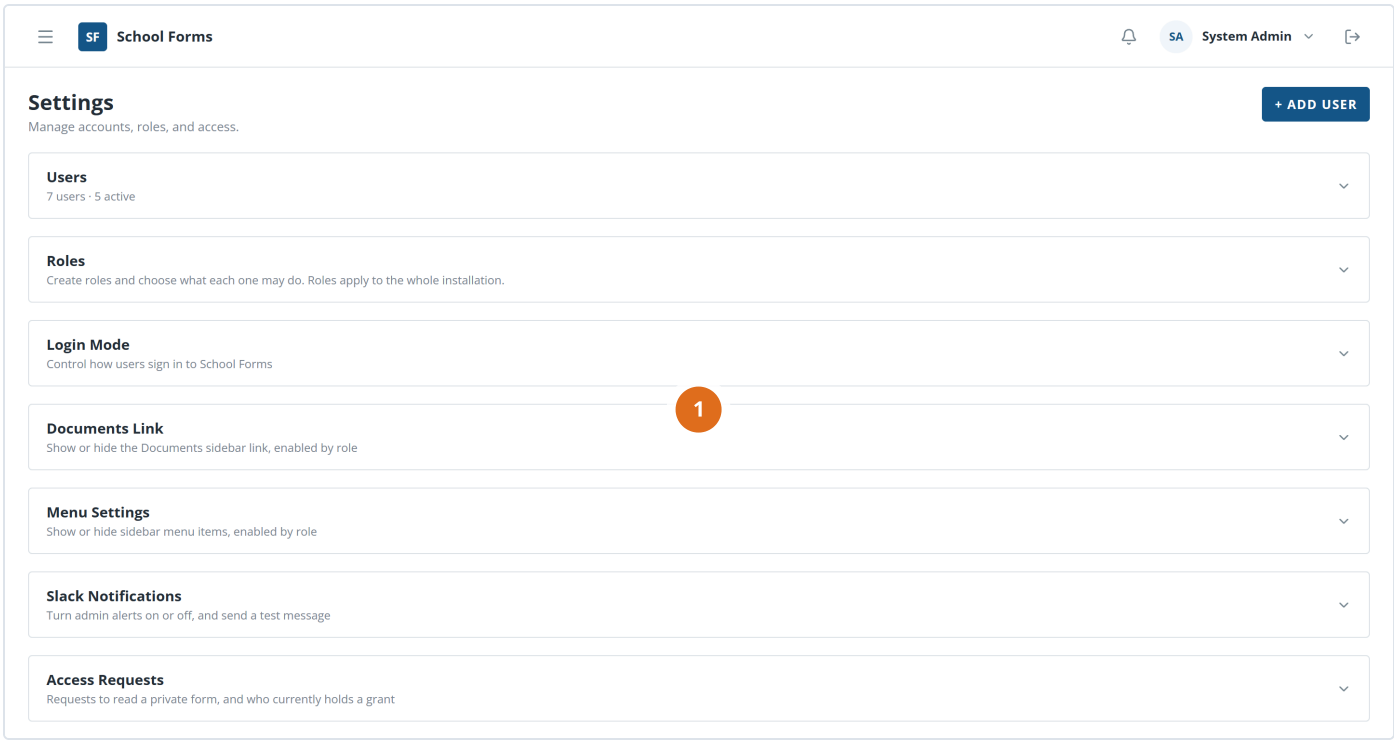


Figure 14 — School Name Matching.

1. A row holds the answer exactly as the parent typed it (*Test School*) and how many submissions carry it. Choose the school it means from the list and save the match: every submission with that spelling is routed to the school, and future answers with the same spelling match automatically.

> **The answer itself is never rewritten**
>
> The submission keeps the parent's own words; the match is recorded alongside. That is why a staff member opening the submission sees the original spelling with a note saying which school it was matched to, and by whom.

> **Check this after a form goes live**
>
> The first week of a new form is when most unmatched spellings appear. Matching them then is far quicker than reconciling a term's worth of submissions later.

14. Settings at a glance

SECTION	WHAT IT CONTROLS	SAVES
Users	Accounts, roles, schools, form access, temporary passwords	Per panel
Roles	What each role may do, and whether it is school-limited	Per role
Login Mode	Password, test-user, or maintenance sign-in	Immediately
Documents Link	Which roles see the Documents menu item	Immediately
Menu Settings	Which roles see which menu items	Immediately
Slack Notifications	Admin alerts on or off; send a test	Immediately
Access Requests	Pending requests for private forms	Per decision
Webhook Log	Recent Google Forms responses, including rejected ones	Read-only
System Messages	Banners shown to everyone or to roles	Per message
Organizations	Tenant boundaries	Per organization
Schools	The district school list	Per school
School Name Matching	Unmatched school answers, matched once and for all	Per match

Where to go next

Day-to-day work — forms, the designer, submissions, reports — is in the Admin Guide. What staff and School Contacts see is in the Staff Guide.